

Daniel Castro

Summary

Accessibility and assistive technology specialist who helps create inclusive, supportive learning environments through practical use of technology. Experienced in assistive technology, document remediation, and UDL, with skills in applying WCAG 2.1 AA and ADA Title II standards using tools like JAWS and Adobe Acrobat Pro. Currently pursuing an M.S. in Instructional Design and Technology (expected Summer 2026).

Experience

California State University, Long Beach (Academic Technology Services)

Instructional Accessibility Support Specialist | January 2026 – Present

- I support faculty in designing and remediating accessible instructional materials across LMS platforms, ensuring compliance with WCAG 2.1 AA, ADA, and Section 508 standards. I project manage remediation workflows, supervise and train student assistants, deliver faculty workshops on accessibility and UDL, and contribute to institutional reporting and campus-wide accessibility initiatives.

California State University, Long Beach (Bob Murphy Access Center)

Assistive Technology Specialist | May 2024 – January 2026 (1 year, 7 months)

- Implement and support approved assistive technology accommodations for students with disabilities through individualized student training, technology troubleshooting, and feedback to Disability Counselors.
- Train students to confidently use screen readers (JAWS), speech recognition, note-taking, and voice control tools; identify and resolve remaining digital access barriers to students across campus services.
- Review and remediate digital instructional materials (PDF, Word) using Adobe Acrobat Pro, CommonLook, PAC PDF Accessibility Checker, and JAWS inspection to ensure compliance with WCAG 2.1 AA, Section 508, and ADA Title II.
- Manage the Assistive Technology Program's hardware, software, and licensing, coordinating distribution, maintenance, and configuration of adaptive tools and resolving compatibility issues with IT and vendors.
- Evaluate and recommend accessible technology purchases by reviewing VPATs, comparing tools, and advising on accessibility and usability standards.

- Develop and deliver ongoing training and outreach on accessible document creation and UDL principles, including co-developing “Style It Up!” workshops and presenting at the 2025 Building Bridges Conference.
- Contribute to campus accessibility initiatives and ADA Title II readiness through CSU ATI participation, digital accessibility audits, and annual reporting.

Kaier, Inc. (JBJ Aquarium)

Digital Media Specialist | Jul 2017 – May 2024 (6 years, 10 months)

- Designed and produced digital and print media using Adobe Creative Suite to enhance product accessibility and visual communication.
- Built and maintained the company’s WordPress website, improving usability, navigation, and mobile accessibility.
- Created and optimized web content, product images, and descriptions, applying principles of clear structure, alternative text, and responsive design.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to ensure brand consistency, efficient workflows, and effective customer engagement.

BuzzFeed

Editorial Video Fellow | Jul 2016 – Mar 2017 (8 months)

- Produced and edited short-form video content for BuzzFeed’s digital platforms, coordinating with creative and technical teams under fast production timelines.
- Managed video editing workflows, captioning, and audio balancing to ensure clarity and accessibility across platforms.
- Configured camera, lighting, and post-production setups to maintain high visual and technical quality standards.
- [BuzzFeed Video Credits](http://www.tinyurl.com/BFMPDan) (www.tinyurl.com/BFMPDan)

California State University, Long Beach (Accessible Instructional Materials Center)

Alternative Media Editor (Student Assistant) | Sept 2015 – Jul 2016 (10 months)

- Produced accessible course materials by converting textbooks and instructional documents into large print and screen-reader compatible formats.
- Reviewed and remediated digital files for accuracy, reading order, and structural tagging, ensuring usability with assistive technologies.
- Operated specialized scanning and digitization equipment to initiate the accessible materials conversion process for timely student delivery.
- Developed foundational knowledge of WCAG, Section 508, and alternate format production.

Education

California State University, Fullerton

Master of Science, Instructional Design and Technology | Expected Summer 2026

California State University, Long Beach

Bachelor of Arts, Film Studies | Graduated Spring 2016

College of the Desert, Palm Desert

Associate in Arts, Liberal Arts, General Studies | Graduated Fall 2013

Skills

- **Accessibility & Standards:** WCAG 2.1 AA, Section 508, ADA Title II, Universal Design for Learning (UDL)
- **Assistive Technology:** JAWS, ZoomText, Dragon Professional, ReadSpeaker TextAid, macOS accessibility tools
- **Document & Media Accessibility:** Adobe Acrobat Pro, Adobe Creative Suite, Allyant CommonLook, PAC PDF Checker, ABBYY FineReader PDF
- **Web & Digital Tools:** WordPress, foundational HTML/CSS, Canvas LMS, Microsoft 365, SharePoint
- **Program Support & Training:** Staff and faculty workshops, one-on-one assistive technology training, student assistant supervision, project tracking, accessibility reporting